

Portions of Henry Lunt Journal – 1853

Saturday – January 1st, 1853

I rose about 5 o'clock A.M., also my wife and all the family and washed our bodies all over with pure water and went on our knees before the Lord and offered up an appropriate prayer. Bro. Shirts and wife and Bro. Lee dined with us, also Father and Mother Whittaker and family which consisted of James, Age 19, and Mary, age 14, and Sarah, age 12. Before we sat down to dinner we all kneeled again before the Lord and offered up a prayer of Thanksgiving, and then partook heartily of a good dinner of roast beef and plumb pudding. Assembled together in the meeting house at 3 o'clock P.M. and after singing a hymn and prayer, commenced dancing. The old men and old women were as active as anyone in the dance, and enjoyed themselves as much as the young people, and I think moreso after an intermission of one hour, met again and enjoyed ourselves exceedingly. There were a number of pieces recited and several songs sung. I would remark that no foolishness of any discription was spoke or sung. Myself and wife, and Father Whittaker and Mary and Mary Ann Corlett performed a piece called the "outcast." It went off well and caused many to shed tears. The whole of the day was a day of rejoicing and thanksgiving throughout our peaceful colony. I recommended the old citizens to make a contribution for the poor yesterday which some of them contributed to freely. The Bishop divided it out and it caused everyone to have abundance. I also recommended the brethren to keep up all the cattle and feed them well, which was generally attended to. We dismissed at eleven o'clock P.M. Thus we spent the first day of the New Year of one Thousand Eight Hundred and Fifty three. It is my prayer in the name of Jesus Christ that I may live more faithful and humble and have more of the wisdom of God, and the Gift of Charity, and also that I may be enabled to overcome every propensity of nature and every temptation and continue firm in the work of the Lord and mighty in wisdom and in counsel even so Amen.

Sunday – Jan. 2, 1853

Delightful and fine, more like the month of May than January. Splendid meeting. Had some excellent preaching by Bros. Lee and Shirts. Sat in council with the organized council from 12 until 2 P.M. Bro. Shirts dined with Father Whittaker, also myself and wife. Attended afternoon meeting. Sacrament administered. I confirmed Wm. Davies, Bro. Bladon had a child blessed and bro. Varley had two children blessed. Several of the brethren spoke and bore their testimony. At the close of the meeting, a Utah Indian came for me and the Bishop for to go to their wickiups and administer unto an Indian who had very badly hurt his knee while hunting deer, fell over some rocks. I went with the Bishop and took some consecrated oil and administered unto him, found the poor fellow suffering with great pain. Immediately after the administration the swelling began to go down. I afterwards had some chat with Arapean, a very intelligent Utah Indian, who came in from Walker. He could speak considerable English. Said that

Walker was trading with the Moquitch's Indians and would be along by and bye and would bring a heap of horses. Attended a Bishop's Court in the evening held at Bro. Wiley's house. The case was as follows: Bro. Wiley preferred a charge against his wife and Adam Nicholson for their unchristian like conduct. It appeared that Bro. Wiley had seen them kiss each other, and after telling Nicholson to not come to his house any more he took no notice but came in and out just as he pleased. They both denied the charge, and after some examination were found guilty and cut off the church. The Bishop reproved them very severely.

Monday – January 3, 1853

Very pleasant fine day. Roads muddy but much better than they have been of late. Had considerable talk with Bro. Bladon and Adams on making Iron. The spirit they manifested was better much than I had seen before, began to feel some of the necessity of trusting in God. Oh Lord do thou humble the hearts of thy servants in this place that they may see the all importance of leaning on the arm of Jehovah for help and support; and that we may be enabled to make Iron and that speedily: for thou knowest oh Lord the want of Iron among thy People in the valleys of the mountains. Grant this thy servants petition I beseech thee Heavenly Father and to thy name I will ascribe the honour praise power and Glory both now and for ever, Amen.

Tuesday – January 4, 1853

Fine pleasant day, very little frost. Edward Williams left in company with several others for the Gt Salt Lake City. I wrote a letter to Snow and Richards. Spent most of the day with Bro. James anilizing Iron ore. Bro. Parks commenced putting down the floor in my house, and agreed to do all the work that was needed in carpentering in the house. I babtized Brother Varley and Bro John Briffiths yesterday morning. Had a meeting last evening of all the brethren concerning the removal of the Big field. I laid the subject open before the people at some length. After considerable litigation, and a great deal said some for and some against removing it. They all voted for to do according to counsel. And the counsel was for to move the field on the south side [of] the creek, and there to make a very small compact field and build a good fence around that Cattle could not possible break through. And then by removing the old field would release all the brethren who were engaged in the Iron works.

Tuesday – January 11th, 1853

Fine day. I was arroused out of my bed this morning by the report of two guns, and soon after which, four Pihedes Indians came into the house, and told us that the Utah Indians had shot into their camp. Soon after this some of the Pihede wickiups were all on fire. It appeared afterwards from the testimony of one of the Pihedes that the Utah's had bought one of the Pihede squaws and the squaw had run from the Utah's and that made the Utah's mad. I went to the Utah's camp and had a conversation with Tab and Chrosefene, the two chiefs, and they appeared very friendly with me. They asked me if I

would invite my people to give them some flour, as they were going to leave this point at noon today. I told them I would and I sent round the Fort and collected some 75 lb. flour, and gave it to them. I told them to see that none of their men drove off any of our cattle or horses. Nephi Johnson interpreted for me. The Utah Tribe left at 12 o'clock, said they were going to San Pete. Myself and wife and Father and Mother Whittaker attended a supper party at Bro. Chatterley's. Bro. J. C. L. Smith came in the evening.

Sunday – Jan. 23rd, 1853

Frost not so severe. Very fine day. Attended meeting in the morning at 10 A.M. Meeting house was crowded so that some had to stand up all the while. Bro. Mitchell preached a very excellent discourse. I made a few closing remarks. Attended the Sunday School in the afternoon, was very much pleased at the good order, and the instructions which were given by the Teachers to the children. The children are learning to sing delightfully and the Spirit of God and his blessings rest down upon the teachers and children. Bro. Shirts dined with me. Attended meeting in the evening. Very excellent meeting. A number of brethren spoke. Ellen bore her testimony. I made a few closing remarks. Counceled the brethren for to have their guns and ammunition on hand and for to take notice and listen to the tales of the Indians, but not to tell them our intentions, as I had heard that the Utah Indians were mad and had said that they would come and kill us some night, for we were cowards and durst not fight them. I have learned from the Pihede Indians that the Utah's killed five of the Pihedes dead and five more were wounded and also stole a lot of children and some women. I would here remark that the Utah Tribe never were half so good behaved as the Pihede Indians, neither are they industrious like the Pihedes. The Pihedes have hitherto as a general thing been peaceable and kind, and are willing to work for bread or anything to eat, and truly they do a vast of work for this people, and may God bless them and inspire their hearts to do right, and to habits of industry and cleanliness.

Saturday – February 5th, 1853

Very sharp frost but fine pleasant day. Removed from Father Whittaker's house to my own house on the new City. Father and James assisted me. I feel very thankful to them and the rest of the family for their many acts of benevolence and charity rendered unto me and my wife. I have it not in my power at the present time to pay them for their work done for me; but if ever I should, it is my desire to pay them for their labour. Father Whittaker has been working for me for the past week. Mother Whittaker furnished us with a number of articles necessary in housekeeping which I was entirely destitute of such as pots and kettles, etc. etc. May the Lord reward them for their goodness. I will in return for their kindness to me, endeavour by the help of Jehovah to prove myself worthy of their good deeds and live a life which may be acceptable to God and show myself to be an honourable member of his Kingdom, and a dutiful son-in-law; and shall ever endeavor to exalt them in the Kingdom of God. In the evening in my usual Evenings devotion, I thanked the Lord for the comfortable house that he had given

me and my wife and asked his blessings to rest upon it; and dedicated it to the Lord. It is adobie house 15 inch wall, 15 by 16. 10 feet high, well finished inside, fronts the south, Lot 5, corner lot, Block 19. The first adobie house built in Cedar City. Praised by Lord for his goodness unto me forever Amen.

Sunday – February 6th, 1853

Very sharp frost. Delightful fine day. Attended meeting. Bro. Carruthers preached an excellent discourse. Our meetings are most excellently attended, so crowded that the house will scarcely hold all the people. Walker, the Indian Chief, and a small band came and camped by the side of the small mountain yesterday East of the Fort. They had a large band of horses. He made inquires for me but I did not see him until today. I went about one o'clock and took along Nephi Johnson for to interpret for me. Father Whittaker and several brethren accompanied me. Just as I was going Bro. Goulds man, who was attending the coal pits, at the Iron works, came running to me and said that one of the pits had bursted out, and set fire to the cord wood. I immediately called out in the Fort that the wood pile at the Iron works was on fire and that I wished for the brethren to run with buckets, which they immediately did. Thinking it wisdom to go and see Walker, the Indian Chief, the while, I did so. When I first entered his tent, which was a very extensive one, he shook hands with me and invited me to sit down by his side on a blanket, which I did. He seemed very quiet and did not manifest a very friendly spirit for some time. When I lived at Parowan I had a rifle which he wanted to get off me for a horse, but not being lawful for to trade guns with the Indians at that time, of course, I did not trade. He told me that he did not like me so well on that account and if I would give him a shirt he would be friendly with me. I told him through Nephi that I should not buy his friendship by giving him a shirt for I was his friend all the time and consequently had no occasion to give him anything on that account. I told him inasmuch as he would do right and his people, the Mormons were his friends. I told him that some of the Utah's had shot some Pihede's and that the Mormons did not like the Utah's for that, for it was very wicked of them to keep killing one another and that the Lord was very angry with them for killing one another. He afterwards manifested a most excellent spirit and said he was mad at the Utah men killing the Pihedes and when he heard of it he cried, he said he was friendly with the Pihedes and also said there were a great number of Pihedes east of this place over the mountains who had never seen any white men yet, and he said they must not steal any of the Mormon's cattle, for the Mormons were a good people. He also said that it was not my fault that I did not trade him my rifle; he said he was Tooich, Tacaboo, which is very friendly with me. I then invited him and Amon, his brother, to dine with me on Monday and he said he would. He also said that they were very hungry and had not any meat, and would be very glad if I would have my people to give them some flour and potatoes. I said I would. He had the large pipe charged and we smoked all round some 20 braves the Pipe of Peace. I then left and attended the afternoon's meeting, Sacrament Sunday. Called for the report of the Teachers, which each one gave in, and as a general thing the reports were very

good. Bro. and Sister Ashworth would not receive the Teachers as Saints should do and manifested a very bad spirit. They were both disfellowshipped from the church until they made restitution to the Teachers. According to the instructions I received from Pres. J. C. L. Smith I informed Bro. Wood and Bro. Benson that they must not receive the Sacrament. Bro. Wood insisted of speaking before the Sacrament was administered. I refused him the privilege as I did not consider it wisdom as Pres. Smith informed them he wished for both of them to meet before the Bishop on Monday night. Bro. Wood manifested a very bad spirit and said that it was not right as he was not allowed to speak. I felt the power of darkness in the room and bowed in prayer to the Lord; after some few remarks by Bishop Smith the meeting was dismissed. The evil spirits had to flee before the rays of Truth and before the dismissal the Evil one appeared to have but very little power. Myself and wife had both dinner and supper with Mother and Father Whittaker. My mind feeling tired with the amount of business pertaining to the upbuilding of the Kingdom of God that I had had to attend to during the day, I retired home and instructed the Bishop to preside at the evenings meeting.

Friday – Feb. 18th, 1853

Very sharp frost, cold north wind. Fine clear day. Mother Whittaker and Sister Catherine Chatterley spent the afternoon with my wife, eat supper with us and also Father Whittaker and Bro. Chatterley eat supper with us. I was pleased to have them and felt truly thankful to my Heavenly Father that I had got a good comfortable little house of my own, that I could make my brethren and sisters comfortable, and find a home for the wearied traveller, and administer to their wants. I am still more thankful that the Lord has given me abundance of food to eat, and peace and happiness in my habitation. May I ever live to the Glory of God and prove myself worthy of his good things being withheld from me is my prayer for Christs Sake, Amen.

Saturday – Feb. 19th, 1853

This morning at ¼ to 5, I was called by four of the brethren who went out with the company on Thursay morning. I immediately jumped from my bed and opened the door, and inquired what news; answer, "good, all's well." Invited the brethren to put their horses in my pen, in the meanwhile I made a good fire for them to warm themselves by as they were nearly frozen. They informed me that the two gold diggers that went along turned back and were killed by the Indians. The company met Bro. Steele & Co. about 45 miles from here all well with 3 loads of iron. Bro. John West lay down in my bed for about 2 hours and ate breakfast with us and then went on to Parowan. I am thankful to my Father in Heaven for the good news and for his protecting care that has been round about my brethren. The two men who were killed I was informed were very wicked, swearing men. Hence fulfill's scripture "The wicked shall not live out half their days." I went over to the Fort in the evening, with the brethren and sisters ready for a day. The balance of the brethren came back in the afternoon and the Bishop gave them a dance. I participated a little in the dance and then returned home.

Monday – February 21st, 1853

Very cold north wind. Blew very strong all day. Saw Walker, the Indian Chief, and conversed with him through Nephi Johnson. Told him to preach to the Pihedes and tell them to behave themselves, and not come into our houses unless they were invited and that they must not insult our women as some had done of late, and that we expected a great many more Mormons this spring. Walker then walked with me home and dined with me, and manifested a very good spirit and told me that he would talk to the Pihede Indians. Bro. Steele & Co. returned with the Iron from Big Muddy. They left 4107 lbs. with us at the Iron works. Went on their way to Parowan in the afternoon. Stormed considerable on the mountains. Bro. Bradshaw came to my house and told me that he would take the job of making the water ditch for to take the water round by the city and to the field for to make it at twenty-cents per yard and would try to have it done by the first of April and would allow anyone to work out their portion if they choosed to do so. I told him he should have the job.

Tuesday – February 22nd, 1853

Very sharp frost. Fine warm day. Busily engaged about the Iron works most of the day. Grub[b]ed up a little sage off my garden. Bro. J. C. L. Smith came to the Iron works about 2 o'clock. We both talked most of the afternoon about the works and different subjects. He returned to Parowan in the evening with Bro. Walkers buggy and carried back Father Gould who was very sick with a weakness in his back. There are a number of brethren who are in the want of wheat that are working at the Iron works and neither Bro. Calvin Smith nor myself are able to get any for them, as the news has lately come from Salt Lake City that wheat is likely to be scarce before harvest. Those in our midst and at Parowan who have wheat to spare will not part with it at the cash price namely, 1¼ dollars per bushel. And as the Bishop at Parowan or here has not received instructions from Presiding Bishop at Salt Lake City he will not part with it for less than the old price, 2 Dol[lars] per bushel. I am sorry to see saints keep their wheat locked up because they think they can make a little more of it by keeping for a while. I have preached over and over again against the principle and instructed the brethren to be liberal minded one towards another and turn out their wheat, those who had it to spare, and not think of speculating out of their brethren and charge them higher because wheat was likely to be scarce. The principal is an old Gentile Devilish principle and therefore was not good for saints.

Wednesday – March 2nd, 1853

Little frost, fine day. Some two or three hundred pounds of Iron out of the blast Furnace early this morning. Dr. Meeks came down from Parowan, and counseled with me on him instructing some of the sisters on the art of doctoring and mid-wifery. I recommended the principle strong, for each one to become his or her own doctor. Myself and wife had supper with Bro. and Sister Chatterley. After supper I invited Br. Meeks and a party of about a dozen brethren and sisters to Bro. Chatterley's house and I

invited Bro. Meeks to give instruction on medicines, mid-wifery, etc., which he did and we had a very interesting and instructive chat together. Sat talking until a late hour.

Thursday – March 10th, 1853

Cloudy morning. Storming on the mountains. Myself and bro. Carruthers went on horseback up the kanyon to the men at the coal bank and examined the mine that was worked in last summer for some 12 years. It was the oppinion of the brethren that the coal was not a "blind coal" as had been said, but that it would prove the best of coal lower down under the solid mountain. We made some little excavation of the snow and earth in search of the coal in various places but could not discover the coal. We returned home however and left the brethren at work removing the snow, which was some two feet deep and more, and snowing very fast all the time, and very cold and stormy. I encouraged the brethren all I could and they were in good spirits as Saints of God should be; and may the Lord bless them and prosper the labour of their hands is my prayer in the name of Jesus, Amen. As bro. Carruthers and myself rode together by the way we talked of the wonderful work of the Lord in these latter days and how he had led us and brought us in the midst of this world of mountains and hid us up as it were in the hollow of his hand, our hearts burned within us with the love of God. We arrived home about 3 o'clock.

Wednesday – March 16th, 1853

Snow fell during the night three inches. Stormed all the day. I spent most of the time in reading John Taylor's discussion with the 3 Ministers at Paris. Bro. Decker lent me a poney for to go to the valley and Bro. Nelson promised to let me have a mule. I promised to pay these brethren for their animals.

Monday – March 21st, 1853

I invited the brethren who intended to work at the Iron works to meet at the casting house at nine o'clock this morning. They did so and I met with them. We spent some time in arranging and organizing things. We all agreed to meet again in the evening and see if we could not get the farmers to haul wood this week for the iron works as we are going to try wood in the Blast Furnace. The farmers were very backward at promising to do anything for the Iron works. I invited them and warned them not to have their minds so much on farming as they were not sent here for to farm. They were sent down here for to go to with all their might and make iron, and let everything else be, especially farming. The Children had a dance in the Evening in the school house. I went in and spoke to them alittle and instructed them some, and saw them dance, and was much amused with them and pleased to see them dance so orderly and keep so good order.

Tuesday – March 22, 1853

The brethren tried the saw wood in the furnace and it melted the iron in the cubulo first rate and had two wheels and two pedestals were moulded and looked splendid. I had

recommended the brethren for to try the Raw Pitch Pine many times even from the first, but they would not. Gave some instructions to the Teachers in the Evening.

Wednesday – March 23rd, 1853

Started with a waggon mule and horse, about eleven o'clock for Gt. Salt Lake City. Robert Kershaw accompanied me and my wife, he lent me his horse. The poney that I got off bro. Decker got out of the pen and could not be found. Bro. George Wood and two wives went with us with two teams. Also bro. and sister Bosnell and sister Cartwright one team. Arrived at Parowan about 4 o'clock P.M. Most tremendous windy night, could not sleep for the dust and wind.

Thursday – March 24, 1853

Wind and dust continued to blow a perfect hurricane. Left Parowan about eight A.M. There were several families left Parowan with us for Salt Lake. Stormed ahead of us most of the morning, excessively cold. Ate supper on the rise of the mountain about 5 o'clock, then rolled on to the Beever, distance I should guess from Parowan 35 miles. Bro. Walker broke his forward axle coming down the canyon. I carried his wife to camp about six miles. No wood, but small willows, very cold night. Camped on the south side of the first stream in the Beever Valley. Tremendous cold frost night. There were seven waggons in our camp and 5 more camped about a mile ahead of us.

Friday – March 25, 1853

I rose early this morning and turned out the horses for to feed. Bro. Bosnell went back to Bro. Walker and helped him to fix up his waggon and got into camp about 12 o'clock last night. Cut a quantity of willows and put them into the creek for to pass over. Started again about eight o'clock, crossed over the creek first rate, had some little difficulty in getting Bro. Woods waggon over and Bro. Whitney's over as their horses were very bad to drive. Did not see or hear anything of Bro. J. C. L. Smith. He and Bro. Leaney started on Wednesday from Parowan for the purpose of breaking out a new road which would be some 7 miles nearer than the old road from Beever to Pine Creek, and we expected for to break the road, but as we did not see anything of them we concluded to continue the old road. The Beever crossing is a bad one – steep pitch into the creek. A short distance on the north side there is another creek which is also bad crossing several of the team had trouble in crossing. Bro. Gallisbie had to be helped out. I crossed at other places first rate. Bro. Walker in crossing broke the iron work in the front part of his buggy and he had to leave it. I took some of his things in my waggon and Bro. Wood the rest into his and had Bro. Walker's horses put to his waggon. About 7 miles from the Beever we met a party going to Coal Creek. They had the mail with them and had been 25 days from Gt. Salt Lake City. They reported the roads very bad and much snow in places. They left Coal Creek the first Thursday in January; they said they suffered much on their way to Salt Lake, Bro. William had a few groceries from Snow & Richards for the brethren in the Iron works at Coal Creek, and had a letter and

an invoice of about nine hundred dollars worth of dry goods and groceries. The letter was from Snow & Richards, it did not contain much news, said they had sent the goods by Bros. Anderson and Watts. They said they expected one of them would visit us at Coal Creek soon but they could not say which or when. About 2 miles further we met three men with pack animals, with the U.S. Mail going to California. Tremendous cold north wind. Camped in the mouth of a kanyon, where Mitchell preached on the word of wisdom the time we first went to Little Salt Lake. Distance about 14 miles from Beever, camped about 3 o'clock, plenty of wood and good feed, which is a luxury to travellers in this country, but no water. Had to convert snow which was plentiful on the south side of the mountains into water. Being very hungry, myself and Ellen made great havoc of a Beefs tongue, Butter, Eggs and bread, washed down by a good cup of tea given to us by Sister Cartwright. Our little camp had a very lively appearance in the evening, with its cheerful fires and the sisters and their little ones sitting around the fires, and some of the brethren telling tales and singing songs. It is twelve months today since I and Ellen were married. About 7 P.M. President J. C. L. Smith called all the brethren together round the large camp Fire and organized the camp into a company. By appointing Silas H. Smith Captain Henry Lunt Clerk Edward Dolton Sergeant of the Guard W. Y., Webb Pilot and Philip K Smith Chaplain. We concluded to let our horses run loose during the night, and a guard was put on. Two men at a time, two hours each guard. I took out the Boxes out of my waggon and made a bed for Robert Kersharr to sleep, as I did not like for him to sleep out on the ground.

Saturday – March 26, 1853

The camp was called up at 4 oclock. Started about 5 oclock. The ground being frozen hard we traveled good unto Pine Creek. Traveled over snow in places from one to three feet deep. I was the 6th waggon. Myself and wife walked part of the road. But little water running in Pine Creek. The grass just beginning to shoot out green. Breakfasted here and bait the horses. Started again from Pine Creek about 10 oclock. We met Mr. Gratehouse about three miles South of Pine Creek, reported himself 3 days from Gt. Salt Lake City, had been detained by a difficulty in the City or would have left with the other men with the Mail that we met yesterday. Mr. Gratehouse is the contractor to carry the mail from Independence U.S. to San Francisco California. The U.S. Govt. pays him 50 thousand dollars per year for the contract. He reported Twenty waggons at Salt Creek bound for Coal Creek, roads very bad. Roads Tremendously heavy to Cove Creek where we camped about 2 oclock P.M. There had been a great deal of snow fall here the last storm. Had to pack our water for nearly a mile up Cove Creek. There was no water where we crossed. Very warm pleasant day. We concluded to start again on our way by 12 o'clock in the night, and go to Corn Creek. I stood guard round the horses from sun down until ½ past 9 P.M, when we drove up the horses, fed them, Harnesed up and started about ½ past Eleven P.M. Delightful frosty night. Had prayer before we started. The moon being but a little past full, it was very light and pleasant, but very cold riding. I walked a part of the way.

Sunday – March 27th, 1853

Arrived on Corn Creek just as the King of day was sending forth his majestic rays of warmth and light over the valleys of the mountains, and the spring birds charmed our ears with their singing. We had pretty heavy rolling through Dog Valley. The new road made through from Dog Valley to Parvant Valley is a most Excellent one and some nearer than the old one. We had good rolling to Corn Creek. We took our horses out, gave them water and a feed, breakfasted and started on again. 9 waggons of us arrived at Filmore City about 12 oclock noon, bro J.C.L. Smith and 2 other Teams stayed behind on Meadow Creek to bait their horses again as they were very poor. Bro Tomkinson came to my waggon and invited me to drive up to his house. I did so, also the other waggons camped nearby, myself and wife went to meeting at the school house, an opportunity being given, I occupied a short time in talking to the saints of our prosperity at Coal Creek, exhorting them to faithfulness etc. Bro. Call made a few remarks and Testified to things that I spoke being True and gave notice to the congregation that there would be another meeting in the Evening and as bro J C L Smith was Expected in the evening. He would expect to here from Bro. Smith and Bro. Lunt. The Sacrament of the Lord's supper was administered. Father Carling invited me and wife to dinner, we accepted the invitation and eat a hearty dinner. Exhibited the hand Irons which were cast at Coal Creek that I brought along with me. The brothers were well pleased at the sight. Bro Smith came up in the Evening and the other two waggons. Bro Smith, myself and Ellen and several others of our brethren attended meeting. Being called upon together with Bro. Smith and Bishop Philip K Smith, I preached a short discourse. Myself and Ellen ate supper at Bro Thomkinson's, went to bed after sitting up some time talking with Bro Thomkinson and others, very much fatiegued and overpowered for want of sleep as I had very little for the 2 night previous. Filmore is a promising place, beautiful location and a very extraordinary valley for bunch grass. There are some 50 families being there in a Fort principally, but some few are living out on their City Lots. There is a Saw Mill; and a Grist mill just began to grind.

Monday – March 28, 1853

I bought a bushel of ground wheat for to feed to my horse and mule, paid one dollar for it. Had prayer and started on our way again. Took our horses out at Cedar Springs and baited them and ate our dinner. Roads were good to this point but rather rough. The roads up the kanyon rising the mountains were heavy rolling, very muddy in consequence of the snow thawing. After ascending the summit and decending the mountain we met two sons of Bro. Ormsby, who crossed the plains in the same co. as I did. They reported their father dead; I was sorry to hear it, he was a good man. They came to me and remembered me well but they were so very much grown that I did not know them. We rolled on to Dry Valley and camped at the point of the cedars and drove the horses down to the creek to drink and brought them back to camp and concluded to tie them to the waggons until the moon was up, and then to herd them during the night.

There were 4 Utah Indians came to camp immediately after we arrived. They told us the grass was theirs, and the wood and land, and wished for us not to stay here, but for to "piquay." They also wanted for us to give them provisions, but we would not as they were not for accommodating us, neither would we them, we told them if they would come in the morning, good natured we would give them some "citcup." We spent a very pleasant evening and had considerable preaching by several of the brethren on the subject of women wasting life by not marrying.

Tuesday – March 29, 1853

Stood on guard round the horses from one till 4 A.M. Thought that Bro. Silas Smith's horses were stolen by the Indians as we could not find them until day light. Started on our way again about eight A.M. Went round by the water to water our horses, arrived at the Severe River about noon, found an excellent bridge which was very accommodating over the Severe River. Baited for about an hour and rolled on again. Excellent road. Met two teams for Iron County, heaving rolling near to Chicken Creek. Baited for about 2 hours. There were several more Teams camped here for Iron Co. , and 3 Teams came up from San Pete, on their way to Conference. Rolled on again some 7 miles, and stayed all night. No wood, water or feed.

Wednesday – March 30, 1853

Started on our way again soon after day light. Arrived at Nephi City about ½ past 9 A.M. Found quite a city here, about 50 families; very pleasant location. The Indians at this point killed a Grisly Bear a few days since. I bought a little fat off them for some flour. Ellen rendered it and got about ½ a pint of grease, which came in first rate for our hair as we have no oil. Started on about 2 o'clock. Stayed about ten minutes on Willow Creek. This is a most splendid location, capital place to raise sheep, being no brush and abundance of grass. Traveled on again about three miles to some springs where we camped. No wood but some little sage brush.

Thursday – March 31st, 1853

Drove up our horses about six o'clock. The wolves had eat off about half of the larriet on the horse. Rolled out of camp about seven A.M. The roads good but rather rough, mostly up hill to summit, found a small settlement here, some dozen houses. Travelled on to Payson, where we stayed an hour and baited our horses. There were some 30 or 40 houses at this point, very pleasant spot and likely to become a great place for raising grain. Distance from the springs to summit 9 miles. From Summit to Payson, 6 miles. Rolled on again about 10 miles and baited our horses for about 2 hours. Saw a large settlement on Spanish Fork Creek to our left called Palmyra. Rolled on again through Springville. This is the finest settlement I have seen on the road. Beautiful for situation, some 100 houses and many excellent buildings of Adobies with shingle roofs. This city bids fair for one of the most delightful cities in the territory. The prairie about Springville is beautiful and green with the new grass and appears to becoming thick like

turf in the old country. Rolled on the way and found ourselves a little after sundown in the midst of a large thriving city called "Provo." There are some two thousand inhabitants in this city, and a great number of most excellent buildings erected, and many more about to be built this spring. It is astonishing to see the rapid progress of the improvements made in the valleys of the mountains. A little over two years since there was not a single house or improvement of any description at Salt Creek, Summit or Spanish Fork and now there are cities being built of immense magnitude and assumes the appearance of an old settled country. There were only 4 houses at Payson when I passed and but an old shabby Fort at Provo and a small one being built at Hobble Creek. I am sorry to say that there were three young men who belonged to the church at Bro. Whipples house with Ball and Chain on for stealing cattle. We met about a dozen waggons between Payson and Springville for Iron County, so they said, but I doubt not but some will not stop until they reach California.

Friday – April 1st, 1853

Rose early this morning. Stopped at Battle Creek at Bro. Johnson's house. I was met at his door with a cup of good strong ale in his hand, pointing it towards me and inviting me to drink. I gladly seized the opportunity and in a few seconds the contents of the cup was down my throat and with a smack of the lips proved it to be good malt liquor of home manufacture. Distance from Provo to Battle Creek 10 miles. Rolled on through American Fork to Willow Creek, distance 15 miles.

Saturday – April 2nd, 1853

Started about eight o'clock, traveled on the upper road, and arrived at Salt Lake City. The G. S. L. City has the appearance of a city to what it had when I left a little over 2 years ago. Some hundreds of houses have been erected in that time and some very good ones too. The Tabernacle is a very fine building, also the Council house and Store house and would grace the City of London. We stayed with some acquaintances of Ellen's, who made us very welcome.

Sunday – April 3rd, 1853

Fine day. Attended meeting in the Tabernacle. Bro. Erastus Snow and Amasa Lyman preached. The order of the day for Wednesday for laying the Foundation Stones of the Temple was read by Thos. Bullock from the Stand. Saw several of the Brethren that I had not seen since I left England. Ellen and I stayed after meeting some time listening to the Choir singing.

Tuesday – April 5th, 1853

Transacted our business at the stores. Found the stores nearly empty. Not a print or a calico to be had. Visited the sugar works and meat shop and public work shops yesterday. Was astonished to find the great amount of machinery and improvements that have been made. To see the machinery, buildings, etc. in this city that are already

erected is a miracle of the present age unparalleled in the world's history. The barren, dry desert truly is turned into a fruitful field and the home of the wolf and snake and wild Indian made the happy peaceful home of the Saints of the most high. Went to see Social Hall and heard the Bands play. Nearly 40 performers, splendid band. Bro. Parley P. Pratt and I had a good deal of chat together. Returned home.

Wednesday – April 6th, 1853

Myself and Ellen witnessed the laying of the corner stones of the foundation of the Temple. There were more than 5 thousand Saints present. To see the order and hear the music and the Troops of Soldiers with their flags and the large flag floating from the top of the Liberty Pole was truly an imposing sight and a day long to be remembered. We attended Conference in the Tabernacle at 10 o'clock. The conference was called to order by Pres. Brigham Young. The choir sung. Prayer by John Taylor. The choir sung again, and then the procession formed at the Vestory and marched to the temple grounds. I saw the Presidency lay the Southeast corner stone and also the Twelve the Northeast corner stone. Bishop Hunter and Council layed the Southwest corner stone and the High Priests layed the Northwest corner. The northwest corner stone was supposed to weigh five tons and the other three about three tons each. There was an oration, prayer and singing at the laying of each stone. The day was delightfully fine and the smiles of an overruling providence beamed richly upon the servant of God and the congregation of Saints as they were engaged in the great and long to be remembered work of laying the foundation stones of the House of the God of Jacob in the Mountains. The ceremony was over about ½ past one P.M. We went to Bro. Kanes and had dinner. Attended conference again in the Tabernacle.

Thursday – April 7th, 1853

Delightful fine day. I and Ellen attended meeting in the Tabernacle at eight oclock. The great Hall soon became pretty full. Father Allred presiding. He made a few opening remarks and gave an opportunity for any one to speak as felt like speaking. The brethren did not fully occupy the time as was wished for, so I occupied a short time myself, the spirit of the Lord was with me, and after I sat down several rose at a time. Bro Heywood Bro Allred and I also told the saints of our prosperity at Coal Creek in the Iron business, after I had spoke, Dr. Sprig brought the hand irons out of the vestry and placed them both on the front of the Stand, the saints appeared quite excited and well pleased at the sample of cast Iron made in the mountains by the Saints. We had an excellent meeting. At 20 minutes to 10, Prest Brigham Young called the Conferance to order. After Prayer and singing Prest Brigham Young made [a] few remarks. Said he had a Text to preach from but he did not expect to finish the Sermon himself but should leave it for his brethren to preach upon. Te Text was “The Right of Heirship” He said it was not right for a man to have a widow sealed to him whose husband had died faithful in the church. Orson Hyde and Erastus Snow preached afterwards. We had dinner with James Bond and his Mother. The officer[s] of the church were voted in again at this

mornings meeting. And several old Brethren chosen to be Patriarch's. Parley Pratt preached in the afternoon. Had supper with Bro Woodruff. Took a walk afterwards with my wife Bro Woodruff and wife round the Temple Block.

Friday – April 8th, 1853

Attended conference in the afternoon. Attended a High Priests meeting in the tabernacle in the evening. Had my name enrolled in the Quorum of High Priests. There were 24 brethren called to go on foreign missions, 19 for England, 2 for U. States, 1 for Germany and 2 for China.

Saturday – April 9th, 1853

After supper I went with Bro. Ferguson and Company to the Court House and heard the sentence passed on 3 men for stealing cattle. One was fined 200 dollars and costs and one year's imprisonment and the other two had the same but six months imprisonment instead of twelve and fined 100 dollars each. The judge told the prisoners that he presumed within two years a thief would have his head cut off if he stole the amount of Ten dollars. I attended a meeting of Seventies in the Tabernacle in the evening.

Tuesday – April 12th, 1853

Bro. Jos. Kane showed me over the printing office. I printed one side of a newspaper. I was much pleased with the process of printing. There are some 8 or 10 men employed in the office. The new press and type cost some eight thousand dollars.

Wednesday – April 13th, 1853

We started on our way to Cedar City about 9 o'clock AM. Called at a number of places in the city, which detained us, and it was about 2 o'clock before we got out of the city. Stayed at Bro. Smoots Little Cotton Wood. Paid Bro. Smoot 100 for 4th of pork.

Thursday – April 14th, 1853

Started about seven o'clock. Met two men with an Express from Parowan. They gave me a letter to read which they had for Bro. Brigham Young, stating that some emigrants had been furnishing Walker's Indians with guns and ammunition and a posy of our brethren went out after them and Walker the Indian with about 30 more stoped them from pursuing them any further and presented their guns at our brethren. The brethren being much smaller company than the Indians thought wisdom for to return which they did, held a council and sent an express to Pres. Brigham Young.

Wednesday – April 26th, 1853

Was confined the house most of this day. Took a walk up to the Iron works in the afternoon. I instructed the brethren for to get the school house enlarged this week and recommended bro. Hewitt to take the job and levy a tax on the people for to pay them for the job.

Wednesday – May 11th, 1853

In the house all day writing. Attended the dance with my wife in the evening. The room was very much crowded. About eleven there was a variety of sweet cakes handed round the room. There was a variety of songs and pieces recited. Bro. Snow preached a most splendid discourse and dismissed the assembly by benediction at about 3 A.M.

Sunday – May 15th, 1853

I gave a few items in the afternoon of council to the brethren which I considered important which were, not to scatter out on the City Lots, and to strengthen the Fort and make it secure, and have the gates locked every night, also for the brethren to have their guns and ammunition on hand and grind up their swords so that they would do some execution if required. Bro. Bosnell stated that some signs of Mexicans had been seen on the mountains near Parowan and that a company of six brethren from Parowan are in search of them.

Wednesday – May 18, 1853

Fine day. Bro Cook ploughed my garden lot. Was busily engaged most of the day in counseling with different individuals.

Thursday – May 19, 1853

Myself and wife planted a few garden seeds in the afternoon. About ½ past 4 P.M. it began to thunder and lightning over Shirts Canyon and in a few minutes the whole heavens were black with clouds and the lightning and thunder began to approach very near and was tremendous loud. The wind began to blow in a most terrific manner and large drops of rain descended. I and Ellen then went into the house. She sat down near to the fire place and I went to the wood pile for some wood for the fire. As I came through the door I pushed it wide open and just as I was in the attitude of laying the wood down by the side of the fire place, the Electric Fluid struck the chimney of the house, accompanied with the loudest burst of thunder I ever before heard. Knocked part of the chimney down, rent the house from top to bottom, blew the mantle piece to pieces, took a piece out of the floor, knocked the bottom out of a keeler which was full of water, a hole into a Box, knocked the plaster off the wall, tore one of the shoes to pieces on my wife's foot, and a large hole into the other took the use out of both of her legs for some time. I had to carry her out of the house and at the same time my own legs were burning with heat as though I had been in a fire. The house at the moment of the tremendous shock was filled with a blaze of fire. We were both of us sensible at the time and are now that had it not been for an overruling providence which had shielded us from the danger we most certainly should have both of us been instantly killed. It was the most awful scene I ever witnessed and certainly will never be forgot. Praised be the Lord for his goodness unto us. Attended meeting in the evening. Bro. Cooks boy was knocked down about 100 yards from my house. Bro. J. C. L. Smith and Carruthers came to my

house a few minutes after the scene, brought a sample of coal, which was of an excellent quality, that the brethren had dug out of the old mine.

Monday – May 30th, 1853

I went with Bro. Yardly for to get a load of cedars for to fence with. About nine o'clock I heard the report of two guns at the Pihede's wickiups.

Tuesday – May 31st, 1853

I went over to the Fort this morning early and a Pihede Indian came to me and told me that two Parvant Indians had been last night and shot at the Pihedes in their wickiups and had drove off two oxen in the night. He said he had seen the tracks and there were some six more Pihede Indians tracing the tracks who would be at the Fort soon. I went over home and eat my breakfast and returned to the Fort, met one Pihede Indian by the name of Moquechee who told me that the Parvants had stolen two oxen and he had tracked them for a considerable distance. I then ran round the Fort and instructed all the brethren who were there in the Minute Company for to prepare as soon as possible, for to go out after the Indians, and as the officers as well as most of the men in the Minute Company were at work in the kanyon. I said I would go and invited Bro. Dan Ross to go but he refused. I asked him for to let some one have his horse but he refused. I bore with him some time and visited him twice, but all of no use. We started about nine o'clock A.M. on horse back. We struck the track of two oxen and the mocasions tracks of two Indians following them. We followed it up in a northwest direction. We passed by a lake of considerable size about 13 miles off from Cedar City and then followed it over the mountains and down a kanyon which led us into a beautiful valley west of the Beever valley, which the Beever River runs through. It got so dark that we could not see the tracks and we camped for the night. No water, no feed, nor no provisions but a very little break which one or two had in their pockets. One of the brethren picked up two little young rabbits and they were soon skinned, put on the fire and eat. The night was very cold and some of the boys had neither coat nor vest, but however we spent the night very pleasant in talking and telling tales.

Wednesday – June 1, 1853

As soon as day break we saddled up and as soon as we could see the track we had prayer and started again on the tracks. We traveled about seven miles and came to the Beaver River, followed the tracks into the Cottonwoods amongst the brush and out again down by the side of the Cottonwoods down the river we discovered a small fire which was burning where the thieves had encamped for the night and it appeared by signs of the cattle that they had not left that place more than one hour. We followed the trail down the river for several miles, and then came in sight of the cattle and the Indians runing them. We then made a charge on them with all the speed our animals could take us. The Indians then saw us after them and they left the cattle and striped off their clothes and took into the stream which was from 4 to 5 feet deep and some 40 feet whide &

swam down under the water. We found their clothes and an excellent rifle, gun, powder, horn and bullet pouch and a fur cap and butcher knife, which we gave all to our Pihede brave, and he seemed most extraordinary well pleased. We explored the river down for some distance but could not find the Savages. There was considerable brush on each side of the river which made it difficult for to see the water. We then concluded for to return home; we did not intend to kill them, we would have taken them prisoners. The cattle proved to be Dan Ross's. Two most excellent oxen. The distance we thought to be about 50 miles. Our old brave shot a hare with Bow and Arrows. We made a small fire and he cooked it for us, and a sweeter morsel I never eat. This valley is well adapted for raising wheat and is a very large valley. We returned for home again with the cattle and thankful to our heavenly Father for our good success and that no blood had been spilt. The day was very warm. We halted several times on the way and arrived at the lake about nine oclock PM where we encamped for the night; we shot 3 or 4 small Rabbits on our way. The Indian, which we christened "Moses," cooked them for us but he and the rest of us were so very hungry that he eat the guts of the first, and we polished up the whole of the remainder with the exception of the Guts, but they were pretty well basted with the contents of the same.

Thursday – June 2, 1853

When the boys came to drive up the horses this morning there were 4 missing. They did not hobble them and they went to their old range. We started with 4 horses and carried along their saddles and called at bro. Johnsons and eat an excellent breakfast and then went on again for Cedar Fort. Found 3 of the horses on the way which the boys wanted to mount, so we did. Met several of the brethren who come to meet us. They were glad to see us, told us that there was great excitement in the Fort and City concerning us. We were welcomed at the Fort by a large concourse of the saints with shouts of joy. We galloped to the far end of the Fort and fired off our guns and gave three cheers and I dismissed the Brethren with the blessings of God.

Wednesday – June 15, 1853

I went up the Kanyon with Bishop Smith, visited the brethren that were working on the road and also the coal mine. The brethren have commenced this week working the large vein; the Bishop and myself measured the thickness of the Coal, and it measured altogether nine feet of pure coal, seven feet in one vein by itself without being intermixed with anything else. It is a great height up in the mountain, the Kanyon is very whide there and a most lovely part of Gods creation can be viewed from the mine. Abundance of feed for cattle and an excellent place for to erect coke hovens and Log Cabins for a few of the workmen to live in. There is a kind of fine clay intermixed with the coal, which is a good substitute for soap.